Phishing email investigation report

Analysis and Threat Assessment of a Simulated Phishing Email

Incident ID	INC 001
Severity	Medium
Date and Time	29/09/2026 18:30
Recipient	Redacted
Analyst Name	Harisankar

1 Executive Summary

This report documents the analysis of a sample phishing email to identify indicators of compromise (IOCs), URLs, Social-engineering indicators, extract indicators of compromise(IOCs) and determine appropriate response actions.

The email was analyzed using MXToolBox, VirusTotal, Ip lookup, Base64 decoder .To examine Email Header information, sender details, authentication results,urls,social-engineering indicators, and other observable characteristics

The objective of the analysis was to demonstrate a structured approach to phishing investigation from initial triage through risk assessment and recommended response

2 Email Artifacts & Header Analysis

Artifact	Findings	Notes
Display/From address	nooreply@qqnyoxisrnb.us	From address

Artifact	Findings	Notes
SMTP envelope sender	naldqxdfvvbfi@google-apple-amazon.chelsea.uk.com.tountas.org	SMTP MAIL FROM / envelope sender
Sending IP	89.252.128.143	Observed sending IP
IP reputation	Backlisted by RATS Spam and Spamhaus ZEN on MX tool box	Blacklisted IP
Reply-To	None	No Reply-To header identified
Recipient	Redacted	Recipient
Subject LIne	□□□□ Urgent Warning! □□□□ Your account has been locked □□□□□□ Save your photos & videos before 09-30-2026 □□□ Renew for free today!	Subject of the mail
Date	29/09/2026 18:30	Received/sent timestamp as recorded
Full-URL	:hxxps://storage[.]googleapis[.]com/worklinks/evrtinggood [.]html#ltRNotfLUKoScdFUvrXMRDlYmXNKnD	Url presented in the Email
Url Reputation	Marked as phishing by security vendor's on Virustotal	Virustotal analysis result
Redirect domain	sidentin.edu.eu.org	Redirection domain

3 Email Authentication Checklist

Authentication check	Result	Details
SPF	PASS	The SMTP envelope domain's SPF check passed for 89.252.128.143. This only establishes authorization for that envelope domain.
DKIM	Not observed	No usable DKIM verification result/signature was available in the analyzed headers.
DMARC	Not observed	No usable DMARC result was available.
ARC	Present	header contains ARC Seal

4 Technical Analysis And Indicators Of Compromise

A .Sender Analysis:

Display address: nooreply[@]qqnyoxisrnb[.]us

Sender Ip Address: 89.252.128.143

SMTP Envelope Sender: naldqxdfvvbfi@google-apple-amazon.chelsea.uk.com.tountas[.]org

The visible From address and SMTP envelope sender differ, indicating a sender-identity mismatch. This mismatch is a relevant phishing indicator, although it does not by itself establish the attacker's actual identity.The ip address **89.252.128.143 is blacklisted by security vendor RATS Spam and Spamhaus ZEN on MX toolbox**

B. Malicious URL & Redirection Path:

The email contains a suspicious hyperlink :**hxxps://storage[.]googleapis[.]com/worklinks/evrtinggood[.]html#ltRNotfLUKoScdFUvrXMRDlYmXNKnD**

The initial URL uses storage.googleapis.com, the resource subsequently redirects the user to sidentin[.]edu[.]eu[.]org/ltRNotfLUKoScdFUvrXMRDlYmXNKnD.The use of Google-hosted infrastructure does not establish that the email originated from Google.

The redirection link :https://sidentin.edu.eu.org/ltRNotfLUKoScdFUvrXMRDlYmXNKnD Marked as phishing by one security vendor on VirusTotal.

C.Social Engineering Tactics

The email contains many social engineering tactics to trick the user to click on the phishing link which is attached with the mail

1. **Impersonation and Brand Spoofing (Authority):** The email mimics legitimate branding by displaying the "Google Gmail" logo and signing off as the "Google Account Security Team" and "Google Trust & Safety". By posing as a recognized, trusted authority, the attacker attempts to lower the victim's skepticism and compel compliance.

2. **Fabricated Urgency and Time Pressure:** Tight deadlines are heavily emphasized across the entire message—such as ″WITHIN 24 HOURS″, ″THIS OFFER EXPIRES IN 1 HOUR″, and ″Deletion Deadline: TODAY – 23:59 UTC". Creating intense time sensitivity forces victims to act hastily before they have time to evaluate the authenticity of the sender address (qqnyoxisrnb.us).

3. **Intimidation and Fear Appeal (Loss Aversion):** The email repeatedly threatens catastrophic data loss with alarming phrases such as "FINAL WARNING – ACCOUNT WILL BE CLOSED", "ALL YOUR FILES... will be DELETED", and "No further warnings will be sent". Phishers exploit the psychological fear of losing personal memories (photos/videos) or vital documents.

4. **Baiting / False Incentive (Greed and Relief):** To make the malicious call-to-action more appealing, the email offers a free reward: "ONE AND ONLY OFFER – FREE 100 GB" to "Renew for free today!". This provides a sudden "relief path" from the threat, incentivizing the recipient to click the "UPGRADE NOW – SAVE YOUR DATA" button.

5. **Visual Deception and Attention Grabbing:** The subject line uses diamond symbols (``) to stand out in the inbox, and the email body employs high-contrast red warning banners, alert icons, and a prominent blue button to direct attention away from irregularities like generic greetings (Dear redacted,) and spoofed header data.

Indicators of compromise

IOC Type	Indicator
Email address	nooreply@qqnyoxisrnb.us
Domain	qqnyoxisrnb.us
URL	**https://sidentin.edu.eu.org/ItRNotfLUKoScdFUvrXMRDlYmXNKnD**
Sender IP	89.252.128.143

4 Recommended SOC Response

Immediate actions

- Quarantine the message
- Prevent additional delivery
- Block malicious domains/URLs where appropriate
- Search for the same sender/IOC across the environment
- Determine whether users clicked the link
- Determine whether credentials were submitted

- Check endpoint/browser telemetry if interaction occurred
- Reset credentials if compromise is confirmed
- Revoke active sessions/tokens where appropriate

Preventive actions

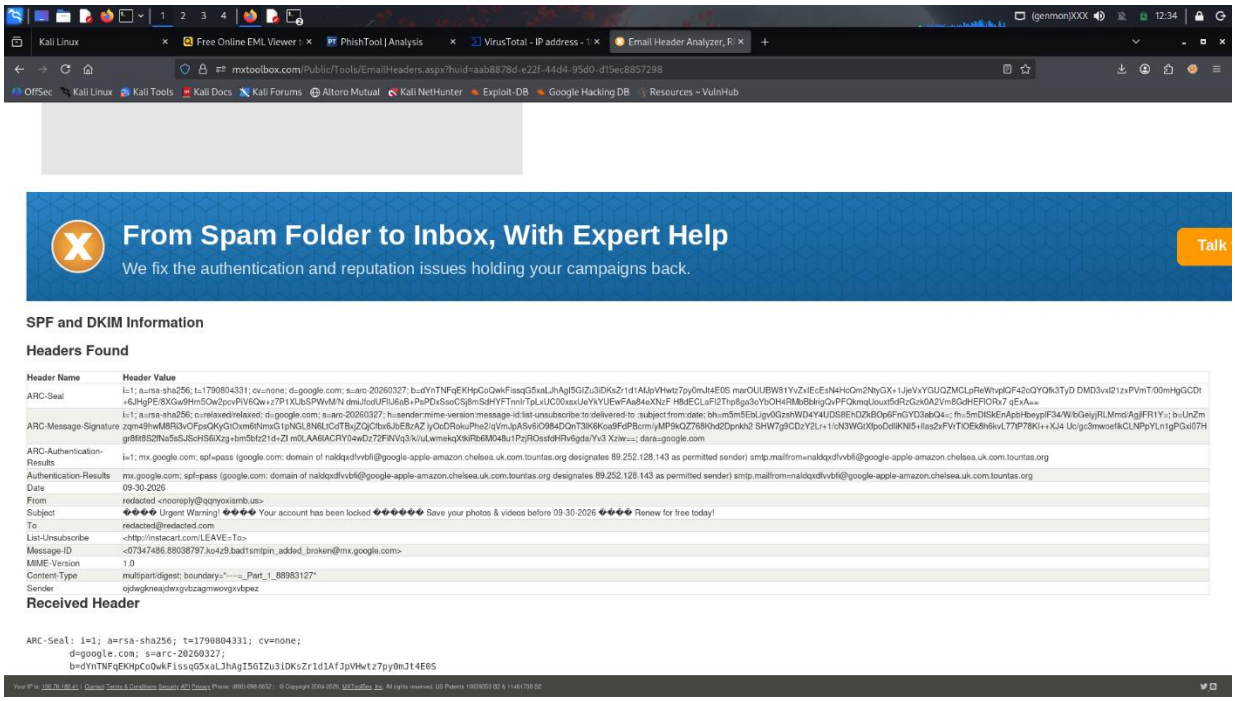
- Strengthen email filtering
- Improve phishing detection rules
- Enable/maintain SPF, DKIM and DMARC
- Implement URL scanning
- Conduct user awareness training
- Monitor lookalike domains

5 Conclusion

The analysed email shows multiple indicators of a **phishing attempt**, including urgency, an account-lockout pretext, a free-storage lure, a deceptive “Manage storage” link, and redirection to a suspicious external domain. The sending IP was also listed on multiple spam blocklists. Although SPF passed, DKIM and DMARC could not be verified from the available headers. Overall, the collected evidence strongly supports classifying the email as phishing.

6 Evidence Appendix:

Email header:



From Spam Folder to Inbox, With Expert Help

We fix the authentication and reputation issues holding your campaigns back.

Talk

SPF and DKIM Information

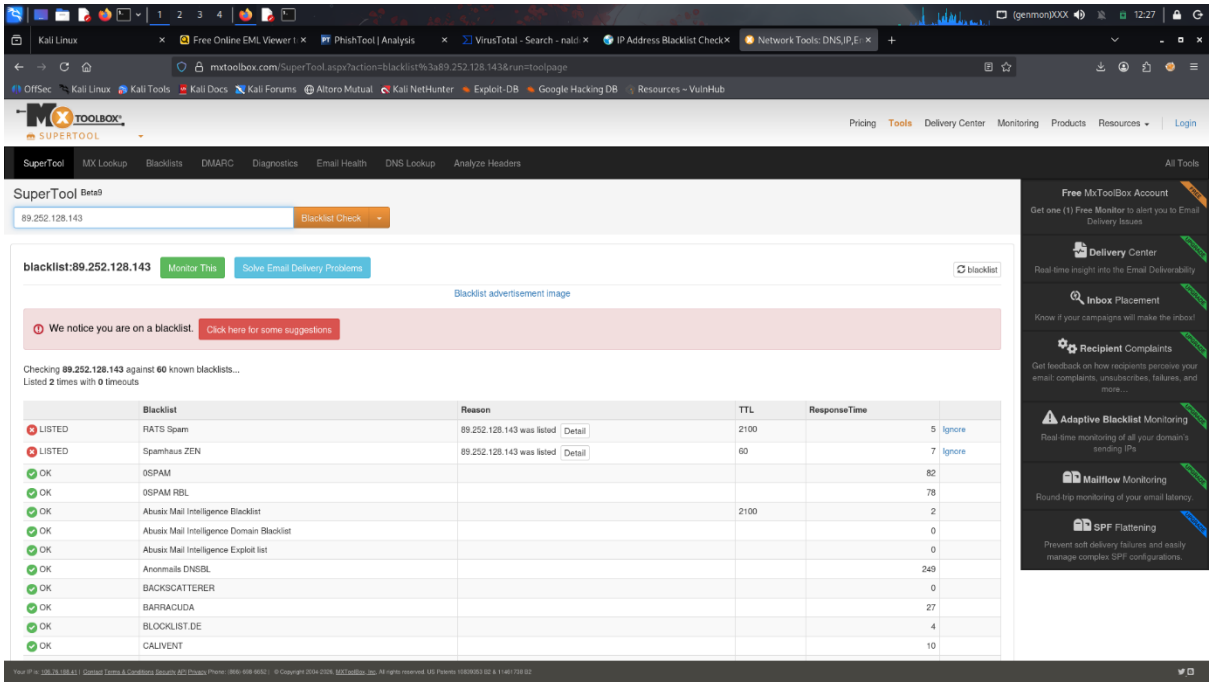
Headers Found

Header Name	Header Value
ARC-Seal	i=1; a=rsa-sha256; t=1790804331; cv=none; d=google.com; s=arc-20260327; b=dYnTNFqEKHpCoQwkFissqG5xaLJhAgI5GIZu3iDKsZr1d1ALpVHwtz7py0mJt4E0S marOUUBW81YvZxIEcEsN4HcQm2NtyGX+1JjeVxYGUQZMCLpReWtvpIQF42cQYOfk3TyD DMD3vxl21zxPVmT/00mHgGCDt +6JHgPE/8XGw9Hm5Ow2pcvPiV6Qw+z7P1XUbSPWvM/N dmiJfodUFlUl6aB+PsPDxSsoCSj8mSdHYFTnnlrTpLxUC00xsxUeYkYUEwFAa84eXNzF H8dECLaFI2Thp8ga3oYbOH4RMbBbRigQvPFQkmqUoux t5dRzGzk0A2Vm8GdHEFlORx7 qExA==
ARC-Message-Signature	i=1; a=rsa-sha256; c=relaxed/relaxed; d=google.com; s=arc-20260327; h=sender:mime-version:message-id:list-unsubscribe:to:delivered-to :subject:from:date; bh=m5m5EbLigv0GzshWD4Y4UDS8EhDZkBOp6FnGYD3abQ4=; fh=5mDISkEnApbHbeypIF34/WibGeIyjRLMmd/AgjFR1Y=; b=LlnZm zqm49hwM8Ri3vOFpsQKyGtOxm6tNmxG1pNGL8N6LlCdTBxjZQjCfbx6JbE8zAZ IyOcDRokuPhe2/qVmJpASv6i/O984DQnT3lK6Koa9FdPBcrmyMP5kQZ768Khd2DpnkhZ SHW7g9CDzY2Lr+1/cN3WGtXlpoDdlIKNI5+Ilas2xFVrTiOEk8h6kvL77fP78Kl++XJ4 Uc/gc3mwoefkCLNPpYLn1gPGxl07H gr8fiIS2fNa5sSJ5cH56Xzg+bm5bfz21d+ZI m0LAA6IACRY04wDz72FiNVq3/k/uLwmekqXtKfRb6M048u1PzjROssfdHRv6gda/Yv3 X2w==
ARC-Authentication-Results	i=1; mx.google.com; spf=pass (google.com: domain of naldqxdfvvbfi@google-apple-amazon.chelsea.uk.com.tountas.org designates 89.252.128.143 as permitted sender) smtp.mailfrom=naldqxdfvvbfi@google-apple-amazon.chelsea.uk.com.tountas.org
Authentication-Results	mx.google.com; spf=pass (google.com: domain of naldqxdfvvbfi@google-apple-amazon.chelsea.uk.com.tountas.org designates 89.252.128.143 as permitted sender) smtp.mailfrom=naldqxdfvvbfi@google-apple-amazon.chelsea.uk.com.tountas.org
Date	09-30-2026
From	redacted <nooreply@qqnyoxismb.us>
Subject	???? Urgent Warning! ???? Your account has been locked ??????? Save your photos & videos before 09-30-2026 ???? Renew for free today!
To	redacted@redacted.com
List-Unsubscribe	<http://instacart.com/LEAVE=To>
Message-ID	<0?347486.88038797.ko4z9.bad1smtpin_added_broken@mx.google.com>
MIME-Version	1.0
Content-Type	multipart/digest; boundary="----=_Part_1_88983127"
Sender	ojdwgkneajdwxgvbzagmwovgxvbpez

Received Header

```
ARC-Seal: i=1; a=rsa-sha256; t=1790804331; cv=none;
        d=google.com; s=arc-20260327;
        b=dYnTNFqEKHpCoQwkFissqG5xaLJhAgI5GIZu3iDKsZr1d1AfJpVHwtz7py0mJt4E05
```

Sender Domain ip validation:



SuperTool Beta9

89.252.128.143 — Blacklist Check

blacklist:89.252.128.143 — Monitor This — Solve Email Delivery Problems

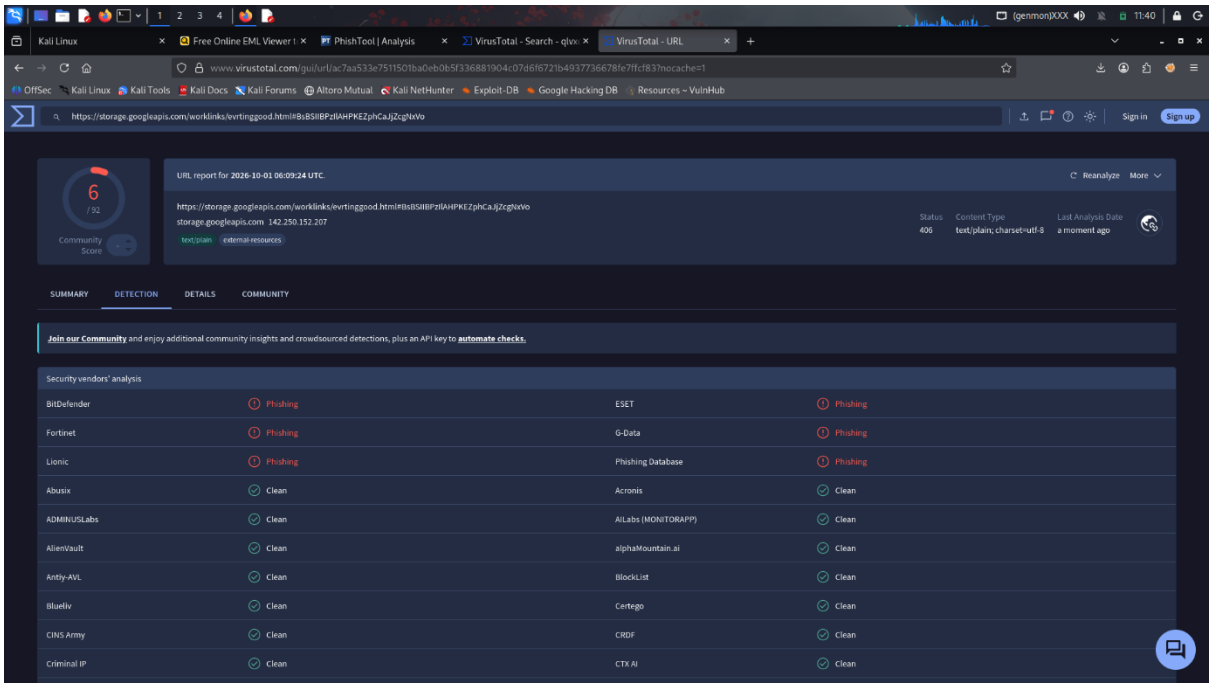
Blacklist advertisement image

We notice you are on a blacklist. Click here for some suggestions

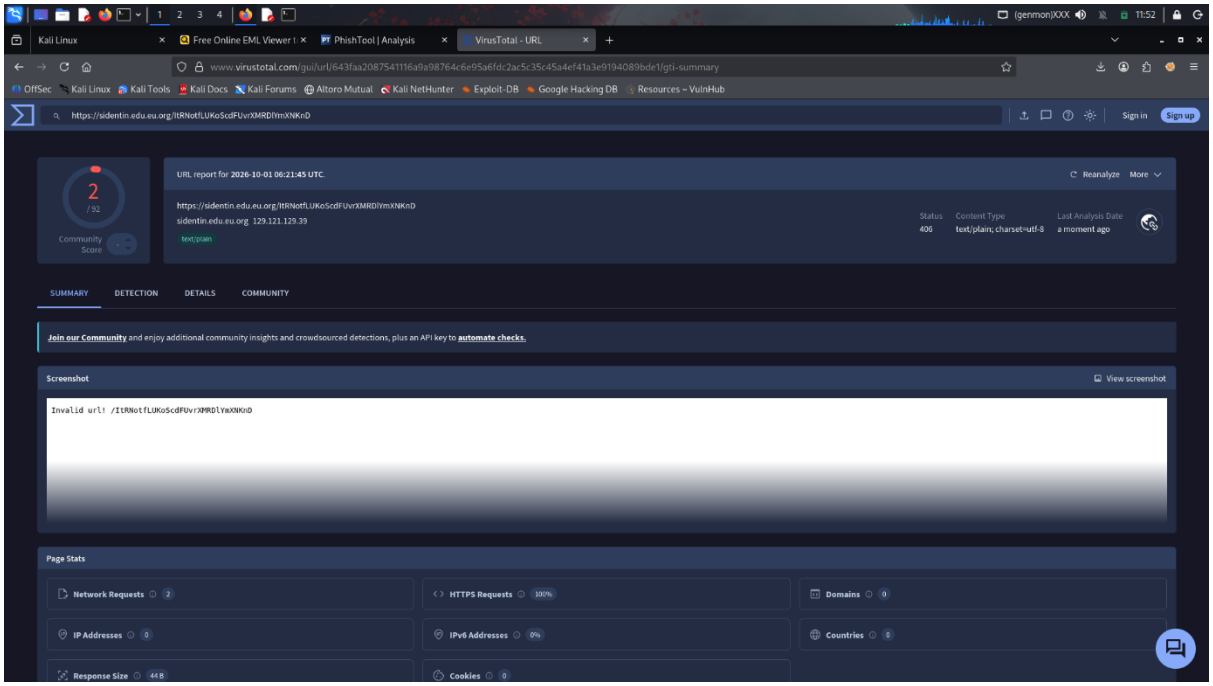
Checking **89.252.128.143** against **60** known blacklists...
Listed **2** times with **0** timeouts

	Blacklist	Reason	TTL	ResponseTime	
LISTED	RATS Spam	89.252.128.143 was listed Detail	2100	5	Ignore
LISTED	Spamhaus ZEN	89.252.128.143 was listed Detail	60	7	Ignore
OK	0SPAM			82	
OK	0SPAM RBL			78	
OK	Abusix Mail Intelligence Blacklist		2100	2	
OK	Abusix Mail Intelligence Domain Blacklist			0	
OK	Abusix Mail Intelligence Exploit list			0	
OK	Anonmails DNSBL			249	
OK	BACKSCATTERER			0	
OK	BARRACUDA			27	
OK	BLOCKLIST.DE			4	
OK	CALIVENT			10	

Email URL analysis:



Redirection URL analysis:



Screenshots of the email received:

